Osman Afridi

Senior Software Engineer | Product, AI Search & Platform Engineering

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PROFILE

Building software professionally since 2009, across web products, AI and search, developer APIs, data infrastructure, and cloud systems. Work closely with product, design, and engineering to turn ambiguous problems into production software, with end-to-end ownership and a focus on reliability, performance, security, and user experience.

EXPERIENCE

GreatSchools | Senior Software Engineer

June 2019 - Present | Oakland, CA

- Own architecture and development across full-stack products and platform systems at GreatSchools, an organization serving 40 million parents annually.
- Built an AI-powered school search engine and supporting pipelines across the application layer, search infrastructure, and AI services, enabling families to search in natural language.
- Designed and built a self-service REST API with payment processor integration and usage-based billing, serving more than one million queries per day.
- Built the initial MCP server and backend API connecting ChatGPT users with GreatSchools information.
- Migrated Jira, Git, and OpenSearch from legacy on-premise systems to cloud-hosted infrastructure. Built a Python workflow to deduplicate millions of school records.
- Mentor engineers, improve code reviews and onboarding, and help shape engineering hiring and AI-assisted development practices.

Technologies: Ruby on Rails, Python, JavaScript, React, search infrastructure, Claude Code, Codex

CustomerLobby | Senior Software Engineer

January 2015 - June 2019 | Berkeley, CA

- One of four engineers helping pivot a reviews product into a customer retention platform. The company saw roughly eightfold revenue growth and was acquired by EverCommerce.
- Delivered revenue-generating projects end to end, including system design, backend implementation, and testing. Built high-throughput data integrations in Elixir and Python.
- Designed an ML pipeline to extract, clean, and label unstructured external data, achieving approximately 85% accuracy while reducing manual effort.
- Led platform migrations and backend upgrades across Rails, MySQL, and Python; mentored junior engineers and supported engineering and QA hiring.

Technologies: Ruby on Rails, Python, Elixir, scikit-learn, Pandas, JavaScript, Redis, MongoDB, Resque, Heroku, RSpec, Capybara

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Earlier experience & technical breadth

EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

Atlassian | Software Engineer

March 2013 - December 2014 | San Francisco, CA

- Built internal applications for plugin approval, issue routing, and ticket escalation, automating operational workflows.
- Improved Lucene-based indexing and search in Confluence. Mentored support engineers in scripting and basic software development.

Technologies: Java, JavaScript, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Apache Lucene, Jira/Confluence SDK, Bash, Velocity

Matchnurse | CTO / Co-founder

January 2012 - January 2013 | UK / USA

- Co-founded a marketplace connecting employers with temporary healthcare workers. Built and operated the platform from application development and deployment to user support and early product iteration.
- Helped grow the network to more than 12,000 pharmacists and 30,000 nurses, and secured a place in a competitive incubator.

Technologies: PHP, LAMP, CodeIgniter, JavaScript

Logica / CGI | Software Engineer

August 2009 - June 2012 | Cardiff / Newcastle

- Worked directly with clients to translate requirements into production software. Architected and built the majority of a security access automation application, saving several weeks of manual effort each year.
- Architected and built a content management system used by more than 40,000 employees. Received multiple awards, including a Diamond Award from external clients.

Technologies: PHP, Ruby, Java

TECHNICAL FOCUS

Product engineering: full-stack delivery, API design, payment integrations, usage-based billing, and collaboration with product and design.
AI, search & data: natural-language search, MCP integration, search pipelines, machine learning, data processing, and data quality.
Platforms & teams: cloud migrations, backend performance, maintainability, mentoring, code reviews, onboarding, and engineering hiring.

EDUCATION

University of Liverpool
BSc (Hons), Computer Science